Yang Liang

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Employment

Associate Professor of Economics, San Diego State University	2025–present
Associate Director, Center for Health Economics & Policy Studies (CHEPS)	2025–present
Assistant Professor of Economics, San Diego State University	2018–2025
Assistant Director, Center for Health Economics & Policy Studies (CHEPS)	2021–2025

Education

Ph.D. Economics, Syracuse University	2018
M.A. Economics, Syracuse University	2013
B.B.A. Accounting, University of Science and Technology Beijing	2012
Exchange Program, University of California, Riverside	2011–2012

Research Interests

Health Economics, Labor Economics, International Economics

Publications

1. "Follow Thy Neighbor: The Role of First Exporters" (joint with Hao T. Fe and Mary E. Lovely), *Journal of Urban Economics*, 2025.
2. "The Effect of E-Cigarette Flavor Bans on Tobacco Use" (joint with Chad D. Cotti, Charles J. Courtemanche, Johanna Catherine Maclean, Erik T. Nesson, and Joseph J. Sabia), *Journal of Health Economics*, 2025.
3. "The Effect of E-Cigarette Taxes on Substance Use" (joint with Dhaval M. Dave, Johanna Catherine Maclean, Caterina Muratori, and Joseph J. Sabia), *Journal of Health Economics*, 2025.
4. "The Effects of Recreational Marijuana Legalization on Employment and Earnings" (joint with Dhaval M. Dave, Caterina Muratori, and Joseph J. Sabia), *Journal of Population Economics*, 2025.
5. "Do E-Cigarette Retail Licensure Laws Reduce Tobacco Use?" (joint with Charles J. Courtemanche, Johanna Catherine Maclean, Caterina Muratori, and Joseph J. Sabia), *Journal of Health Economics*, 2024.
6. "Mandatory Seatbelt Laws and Traffic Fatalities: A Reassessment" (joint with D. Mark Anderson and Joseph J. Sabia), *Journal of Applied Econometrics*, 2024.
7. "Can Exports Be Pain Relievers? The Effect of Exports on Workplace Safety and Health" (joint with Ling Li), *Review of International Economics*, 2024.
8. "Targeted Liberalization: China's Foreign Investment Regulation Reform and Its Post-WTO-Accession Export Surge" (joint with Mary E. Lovely and Hongsheng Zhang), *Review of International Economics*, 2025.
9. "Recreational Marijuana Laws and Teen Marijuana Use, 1993–2021" (joint with D. Mark Anderson, Hao T. Fe, and Joseph J. Sabia), *JAMA Psychiatry*, 2024.
10. "Recreational Marijuana Legalization and Workplace Injuries Among Younger Workers" (joint with Ling Li, Joseph J. Sabia and Dhaval M. Dave), *JAMA Health Forum*, 2024.
11. "Have Recreational Marijuana Laws Undermined Public Health Progress on Adult Tobacco Use?" (joint with Dhaval Dave, Michael F. Pesko, Serena Phillips, Joseph J. Sabia), *Journal of Health Economics*, 2023.
12. "Association Between State Antibullying Policies and Suicidal Behaviors Among Lesbian, Gay, Bisexual, and Questioning Youth" (joint with Daniel I. Rees, Joseph J. Sabia, and Cooper Smiley*), *JAMA Pediatrics*, 2023.
13. "Offshoring, Exports and Employment: Theory and Evidence from Korean Firms" (joint with Jae Yoon Lee, Devashish Mitra, and Priya Ranjan), *The World Economy*, 2021.

14. "Job Creation and Job Destruction: The Effect of Trade Shocks on U.S. Manufacturing Employment", *The World Economy*, 2021.
15. "Economic Geography and Inequality in China: Did Improved Market Access Widen Spatial Wage Differences?" (joint with Mary E. Lovely and Hongsheng Zhang), *China Economic Review*, 2019.

Working Papers

16. "Can Anti-Vaping Policies Curb Drinking Externalities? Evidence from E-Cigarette Taxation and Traffic Fatalities" (joint with Dhaval M. Dave, Johanna Catherine Maclean, Joseph J. Sabia, and Matthew Braaksma*) NBER WP 30670.
17. "Robots and Crime" (joint with Joseph J. Sabia and Dhaval M. Dave) NBER WP 33603.
18. "Do Vaping Taxes Tip the Scale? The Effect of E-Cigarette Taxation on Obesity" (joint with Charles J. Courtemanche, Tessie Krishna, Joseph J. Sabia, and Anthony Chuo), NBER WP 33890.
19. "Are E-Cigarette Taxes Losing their Bite?" (joint with Dhaval M. Dave, Tessie Krishna, and Joseph J. Sabia), NBER WP 34544.
20. "Surviving the U.S.-China Trade War? Evidence from Chinese Exporters" (joint with Laura E. Connolly, Jiajun Lu, and Shuo Zhang)
21. "Bots and Trade at the Ballot Box: The Impact of Automation and Imports on U.S. Elections" (joint with Devashish Mitra and Shuo Zhang)

Book Chapters and Policy Work

22. "Reflecting on the China Shock: A Decade of Learning and Assessment" in Priyaranjan Jha and Devashish Mitra (eds.), *Elgar Encyclopedia of International Trade*, Edward Elgar Publishing, pp. 166–172, 2026.
23. "The Effects of Recreational Marijuana Legalization on Employment and Earnings" in *Research Briefs in Economics Policy No. 347*, CATO Institute, 2023. (with Dhaval M. Dave, Caterina Muratori, and Joseph J. Sabia)
24. "Trump Tariffs Primarily Hit Multinational Supply Chains, Harm U.S. Technology Competitiveness" (joint with Mary E. Lovely) *Policy Brief 18—12*, Washington: Peterson Institute for International Economics, 2018.
25. "They Saved the Worst for Last: Why Trump's Impending December Tariffs on China Should Be Rolled Back" (joint with Mary E. Lovely) *Trade and Investment Policy Watch*, Washington: Peterson Institute for International Economics, 2019.
26. "State Enterprise Reform in China: Grasp or Release?" in Wei-Chiao Huang and Huizhong Zhou (eds.), *The Impact of China's Rise on the Pacific and the World*, W.E. Upjohn Institute for Employment Research, Kalamazoo, MI, 2018. (with Mary E. Lovely)
27. "¿Necesita México libre comercio con Estados Unidos?" *Estudios Fronterizos*, 2022. (with James Gerber)

Seminar and Conference Presentations

Universidad Alberto Hurtado (Virtual), iHEA	2025
UNCW, SEHO (Singapore), ASHEcon (San Diego), WEAI (Seattle), SEA (DC)	2024
WEAI (San Diego), APPAM (Atlanta), University of New Mexico	2023
WEAI (Portland), APPAM (DC), UEA (DC)	2022

Departmental Service

Applied Micro Seminar Co-Organizer	2021–present
Graduate Co-Advisor, Department of Economics	2025–present
Graduate Committee, Department of Economics	2024–present
Department Hiring Committee	2020–present
Undergraduate Committee, Department of Economics	2019–2024
Department Coordinator, Department of Economics	2019–2020

*(student coauthor)

Referee

American Journal of Health Economics, American Journal of Preventive Medicine, China Economic Review, Economics Letters, Economic Modelling, Economics and Human Biology, Economics and Politics, Empirical Economics, Forum for Health Economics & Policy, Health Economics, Journal of the Association of Environmental and Resource Economists, Journal of Health Economics, Journal of Labor Research, Journal of Policy Analysis and Management, Journal of Population Economics, Korean Economic Review, Latin American Economic Review, Review of International Economics, Review of Economics of the Household, Review of World Economics, Regional Science and Urban Economics, Urban Studies, The World Economy.

Awards, Grants, and Fellowships

Division of Research and Innovation Assigned Time	2024, 2025
Seed Grant Program, SDSU ($9,500; $7,350)	2023, 2024
Research Team Grant, SDSU	2023
Critical Thinking Grant, SDSU	2022, 2024
University Grants Program, SDSU ($10,000)	2021
Center for Health Economics and Policy Studies Research Fellow, SDSU	2019–present

Teaching

Main Instructor: Econometrics, International Economics, Public Economics, Intermediate Microeconomics, Stata/R Bootcamp.

Student Advisement

Graduate Students (Ph.D. Placement)

Joaquin Arellanes (University of Georgia, Public Policy Ph.D.)
Anthony Chuo (UT Austin, Economics Ph.D.)
Christian Pryfogle (U of Oregon, Economics Ph.D.)
Cooper Smiley (University of Georgia, Public Policy Ph.D.)
Matt Braaksma (U of Minnesota, Economics Ph.D.)
Russ Leonard (UC Irvine, Economics Ph.D.)
Rebecca Margolit (Cornell University, Economics Ph.D.)
Yiying Yang (Fordham University, Economics Ph.D.)
Xinyue Zhang (Rice University, Computer Science Ph.D.)

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